

art

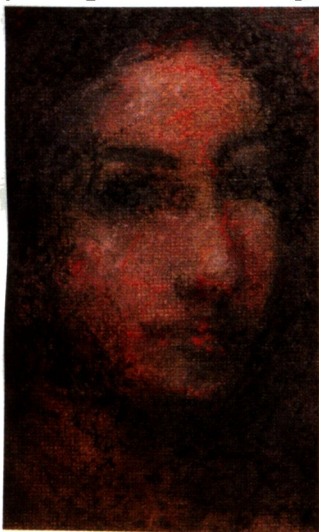
Traveller in Time

KOLKATA For artist Suhas Roy, it is important to provide variety. The veteran painter, whose career spans several decades, has delved into myriad themes, varied mediums and equally varied techniques in his works. As he presents a solo show of his recent works, titled *Drops of Silence*, Roy has drawn on many of his influences over the years.

The only painting that has not been done this year is a huge work of Jesus Christ, which is a theme that he has been exploring for many years now. "He is a legendary figure. His suffering and dedication to mankind has influenced me," he says.

Roy, who studied printmaking in France on a scholarship by the French government, has not done graphics for the last 12 years. But some of his old graphics also find place in the show. Roy began modestly in Kolkata as an immigrant from Bangladesh. He had to fight a rather grim battle of survival as a student in the local art college.

ARTISTIC DROPS: An untitled work by Roy (left); a painting of Goddess Durga

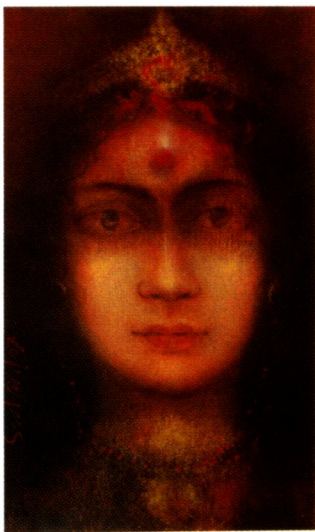


His stint as an art teacher was also not very inspiring since the institution (Indian Art College) where he taught was in a state of confusion and chaos.

The sudden receipt of a scholarship by the French government should have come as a booster, but Roy chose to roam around European art places than stick to learning Western art techniques. His next assignment, as a teacher in a serene Santiniketan, was more fruitful as he found here time to think and imbibe multifarious influences. For a whole decade in Santiniketan, he painted landscapes and the Santhal women.

One of his greatest inspirations, one that still pervades over him, is Radha. "I am fascinated by how a simple girl transformed into Radha, our mythological goddess and lover of Lord Krishna," he says. He has painted Radha in a variety of media such as charcoal and tempera. Some of Roy's other equally interesting works can be seen in the current exhibition. At Akar Prakar till December 24.

by Swagata Sen

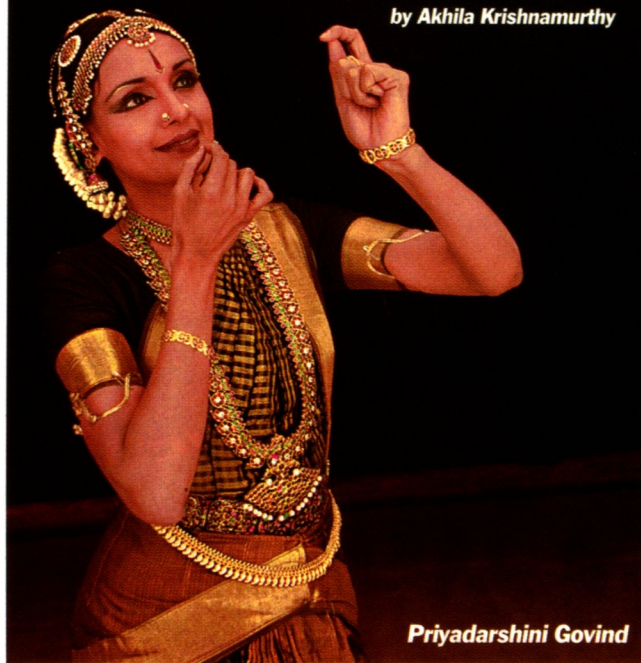


dance

Grace of Movement

CHENNAI Sensuality in Indian dance is the central theme of Karthik Fine Arts' seventh dance conference slated for December 22-24 at the Bharatiya Vidya Bhavan. Helming this convention will be acclaimed dancer and choreographer Priyadarshini Govind, while eminent artistes from the city will discuss the subject in classical texts. "This conference aims to throw light on the various aspects of sensuality in our dance forms," says Govind. The three-day session comprises lecture demonstrations by Leela Samson, T.M. Krishna and Chitra Sundaram, all of whom will offer their own perspectives on erotica in traditional dance. To make the sessions more interactive, the academy has created a website www.natyadarshan.org wherein those interested can post their comments.

by Akhila Krishnamurthy

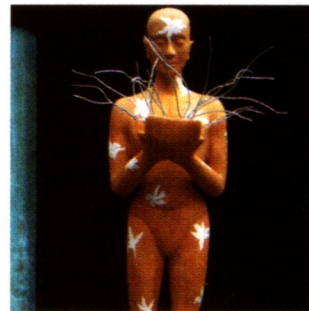


Priyadarshini Govind

art

Glass of Emotions

CHENNAI Artist Hemi Bawa's solo show *Reflections* chronicles its creator's myriad expressions in glass. It is through crafting with this material that she manifests her core preoccupation—"evolution of man in society and one's combat with emotions while masking the agenda of life". "Glass is challenging, its inherent contradictions intrigue



A sculpture to be exhibited me," says Bawa who combines glass with aluminum, copper and stone in her creations. At Apparao Galleries. Till December 20.

by Akhila Krishnamurthy